

NEERAJ GULIA

Engineering Manager | Principal Solutions Architect

Enterprise Platform, Cloud & AI Transformation | DevSecOps · SRE · SDLC · GenAI · MLOps | Multi-Cloud (AWS · Azure · GCP)

+91-9716753718 • neerajgulia92@gmail.com • linkedin.com/in/NeerajGulia92 • Gurugram, Haryana, India

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Engineering Manager and Principal Solutions Architect with **11+ years** of progressive leadership across **cloud architecture, platform engineering, DevSecOps, SRE, and AI/GenAI transformation** for global enterprise environments. Directly manages and grows engineering teams, conducting performance reviews, career development, hiring, and mentoring — with P&L ownership across **\$100K–\$5M program portfolios**. Deep expertise in **multi-cloud (AWS, Azure, GCP)**, Kubernetes-native platforms, **CI/CD, GitOps, SDLC automation, and DevSecOps** pipelines, and production **GenAI platforms** including **RAG pipelines and MLOps**. Experienced in CXO advisory, presales-to-delivery ownership, and establishing **GCC engineering centers of excellence**.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led enterprise cloud transformation spanning **1,500+ VMs and 300+ applications & microservices** across multi-cloud environments — enabling multi-million-dollar modernization outcomes
- Enabled **\$100K–\$5M architecture-led deal wins** through presales solutioning, RFP/HLD/LLD ownership, and CXO-level advisory engagements
- Reduced cloud migration assessment timelines from **3 weeks to 10 minutes** by engineering AI-driven automation using LLMs, Python, and automated discovery pipelines
- Delivered **~30% cloud cost optimization (~\$500K annual savings per client)** through FinOps-driven architecture and rightsizing across FSI enterprise accounts
- Achieved **99.95% platform uptime and ~45% MTTR reduction** through reliability-first SRE architecture, observability tooling, and incident management frameworks

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EKS, EC2, Bedrock, S3, RDS, IAM) · Azure (AKS, DevOps, Azure OpenAI, Microsoft Entra ID) · GCP · Multi-Cloud · Hybrid Cloud · Landing Zone · FinOps

DevSecOps & CI/CD: Jenkins · GitHub Actions · GitOps · ArgoCD · DevSecOps · SDLC Automation · Policy as Code · SAST/DAST · Release Management

SRE & Observability: SRE · OpenTelemetry · Datadog · Prometheus · Grafana · New Relic · ELK Stack · APM · Distributed Tracing · Incident Management

Architecture: Enterprise Architecture · Distributed Systems · Microservices · Event-Driven · Cloud-Native · HA/DR · API Design · Migration · Modernization

Containers & Orchestration: Kubernetes · EKS · AKS · Docker · Helm · ArgoCD · Istio · Service Mesh · RBAC · Container Security · Cluster Autoscaling

IaC & Automation: Terraform · CloudFormation · Ansible · ARM Templates · Bicep · Python · Bash · Infrastructure Automation

AI / GenAI / MLOps: GenAI Platform Engineering · RAG Pipelines · LangChain · LangGraph · Vector Databases (Pinecone) · LLMs · MLOps · Kubeflow · Airflow · AIOps · Embeddings · AI Infrastructure

Leadership & Strategy: Engineering Management · P&L Ownership · CXO Advisory · Presales → Delivery · GCC Leadership · Team Scaling · Org Design · SDLC Governance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Engineering Manager & Principal Solutions Architect

Feb 2024 – Present

AHEAD — Gurugram, India

Own architecture direction, engineering management, and full delivery lifecycle across cloud, platform, DevSecOps, and AI transformation programs. Drive presales through execution for a mixed enterprise portfolio, managing a cross-functional engineering organization spanning cloud, SRE, DevSecOps, and AI workstreams.

- Directly manage **5–8 engineers** (20+ org-wide) — performance reviews, career development planning, promotion advocacy, and end-to-end hiring; **built engineering capability** through structured growth plans, certification programs, and deliberate senior-to-junior pairing
- Led **cross-functional teams spanning cloud, platform, SRE, and AI disciplines** — aligning engineering execution with customer outcomes and business priorities; fostered a **high-trust engineering culture** through structured 1:1s, open feedback loops, retrospectives, and psychological safety — navigating team conflict and delivery pressure while maintaining cohesion
- Provided **interim leadership for a 50-member platform organization** during leadership transition — establishing ownership models, improving incident response processes, and maintaining delivery continuity until new leadership onboarding
- Architected and delivered **enterprise cloud transformation spanning 1,500+ VMs and 300+ applications** across multi-cloud environments — driving multi-million-dollar modernization outcomes
- Enabled **\$100K–\$5M architecture-led deal wins** through RFP responses, HLD/LLD solution design, presales solutioning, and CXO-level advisory engagements
- Reduced migration assessment timelines from **3 weeks to 10 minutes** by engineering AI-driven automation using Python, LLMs, and automated cloud discovery pipelines
- Designed and deployed enterprise **GenAI platforms** using RAG pipelines, LangChain, LangGraph, Pinecone vector databases, and MLflow MLOps workflows — accelerating AI production adoption
- Implemented **Time and Space based CNN** for real-time monitoring of data streams — detecting data divergence before reaching production models, improving model reliability and reducing silent data quality failures

Tech: AWS (EKS, Bedrock, IAM) · Azure (AKS, Azure OpenAI, Entra ID) · GCP · Kubernetes · Terraform · GitHub Actions · ArgoCD · LangChain · LangGraph · Pinecone · MLflow · Python

Solutions Architect — Cloud & Platform Engineering

2021 – 2023

Rackspace Technology — Gurugram, India

Customer-facing Solutions Architect for enterprise FSI and banking clients — owning cloud transformation strategy, AWS/Azure Well-Architected Reviews, and multi-cloud roadmap definition at CXO level across AWS, Azure, and GCP.

- Delivered ~30% cloud cost reduction (~\$500K annual savings per client) through FinOps-driven architecture optimization, rightsizing, and reserved capacity planning across FSI enterprise accounts
- Achieved 99.95% platform uptime and ~45% MTTR reduction via SRE practices, chaos engineering, and observability tooling using Datadog, Prometheus, Grafana, and OpenTelemetry
- Designed cloud-native, event-driven, distributed architectures on AWS and Azure for mission-critical financial workloads — incorporating EKS, microservices, API gateways, and HA/DR patterns
- Designed and implemented a CloudHSM-based Credit/Debit Card PIN generation system for a European bank — replacing carbon-printed PIN generation with a secure, HSM-backed digital solution meeting PCI-DSS and regulatory compliance requirements
- Re-architected an EMR-based real-time streaming platform — reduced infrastructure vulnerabilities from 1,200 to under 20 through security hardening, dependency remediation, and platform modernization

Tech: AWS (EKS, CloudFormation, IAM) · Azure (AKS, Microsoft Entra ID) · Terraform · Ansible · Datadog · Prometheus · Grafana · Kubernetes · Helm · SRE · FinOps

Principal DevOps Engineer — Cloud Platform

2019 – 2021

AVL — Gurugram, India

Designed and delivered cloud-native data and streaming platforms for next-generation ADAS and automotive validation systems across a distributed multi-cloud environment. Drove SDLC modernization and platform engineering for globally distributed engineering teams.

- Built cloud-native streaming and data platforms for ADAS telemetry ingestion and real-time event processing using Kubernetes, Kafka, and cloud-native AWS/Azure services
- Engineered CI/CD pipelines and SDLC automation frameworks using Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Terraform, Docker, and Helm — improving release velocity and testing scalability by 40%+
- Drove microservices adoption and containerization of legacy validation systems, partnering with global engineering teams to accelerate platform modernization

Tech: Kubernetes · Docker · Helm · Kafka · Terraform · Jenkins · GitHub Actions · AWS · Azure · GitOps · CI/CD · SDLC Automation

DevOps Engineer — Cloud SME

2018 – 2019

HCL Technologies — Gurugram, India

Deployed and operated large-scale, auto-scalable cloud infrastructure on AWS supporting national-scale OTT live streaming with extreme reliability and traffic surge requirements.

- Deployed auto-scalable AWS cloud platforms supporting 18M+ concurrent users with zero downtime during high-traffic IPL live streaming events and peak national broadcast traffic
- Engineered infrastructure architecture, CI/CD pipelines, and performance automation for high-availability streaming — implementing auto-scaling, ELB, CloudFront CDN, and DR failover mechanisms

Tech: AWS (EC2, ELB, Auto Scaling, CloudFront, CloudWatch, S3) · CI/CD · Jenkins · Bash · Linux · HA · Disaster Recovery · Performance Engineering

Cloud Systems Engineer

2014 – 2018

Ericsson — Gurugram, India

Built foundational expertise in Linux systems, high-availability infrastructure, and cloud operations within a large-scale telecom engineering environment.

- Automated monitoring, patching, release management, and operational workflows across 500+ Linux servers using Ansible and Shell scripting — improving release stability and reducing manual overhead
- Engineered high-availability infrastructure and network configurations supporting telecom-grade uptime requirements; developed expertise in TCP/IP networking, VLAN design, and Linux administration

Tech: Linux · Ansible · Bash · Shell Scripting · High Availability · TCP/IP Networking · CI/CD · SDLC · Cloud Infrastructure · Monitoring · Release Management

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS	Solutions Architect – Associate & Professional · DevOps Engineer – Professional · Security Specialty · AI Practitioner · ML Associate
Kubernetes	Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) · Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS)
Azure	Azure Architect Professional
Other	Terraform Associate · Docker Certified Associate · Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA) · ITIL v2 · Zerto Certified Associate

EDUCATION

B.Tech – Electronics & Communications Engineering

2010 – 2014

MDU Rohtak, Haryana